

Rainbow's End

..A NOVEL.

BY REX BEACH

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"The Iron Trail," "The Spoilers"
"Heart of the Sunset," etc.

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CHAPTER XIII.

The City Among the Leaves and the City of Beggars.

The night was moonless and warm. An impalpable haze dimmed the starlight, only the diffused illumination of the open sea enabled the passengers of the Fair Play to identify that blacker darkness on the horizon ahead of them as land. Major Ramos was on the bridge with the captain. Two men were taking soundings in a blind search for that steep wall which forms the side of the old Bahama channel. When the lead finally gave them warning, the Fair Play lost her headway and came to a stop, rolling lazily.

Major Ramos spoke in a low tone from the darkness above, calling for a volunteer boat's crew to reconnoiter and to look for an opening through the reef. Before the words were out of his mouth O'Reilly had offered himself.

Ten minutes later he found himself at the steering of one of the ship's lifeboats, heading shoreward. There was a long night's work ahead; time passed, and so O'Reilly altered his course and cruised along outside the white water, urging his crew to luster strokes.

A mile—two miles—it seemed like ten to the taut oarsmen, and then a black hiatus of still water showed in phosphorescent foam. O'Reilly explored it briefly; then he turned back toward the ship. Soon he and his crew were aboard and the ship was groping her way toward the break in the reef. Meanwhile, her deck became a scene of feverish activity; out from her hold came cases of ammunition and medical supplies; the fieldpiece on the bow was hurriedly dismounted; the small boats, of which there was an extra number, were swung out, with the result that when the Fair Play had maneuvered as close as she dared everything was in readiness.

O'Reilly took the first load through, and discharged it upon a sandy beach. Every man tumbled overboard and waded ashore with a packing case; he dropped this in the sand above high-tide mark, and then ran back for another. It was swift, hot work. From the darkness on each side came the sounds of other boat crews similarly engaged.

Daylight was coming when the last boat cast off and the Fair Play, with a hoarse, triumphant blast of her whistle, faded into the north, her part in the expedition at an end.

Dawn showed the voyagers that they were indeed fortunate, for they were upon the mainland of Cuba, and as far as they could see, both east and west, the reef was unbroken. Men were



Ten Minutes Later He Found Himself at the Steering Oar.

lolling about, exhausted, but Major Ramos allowed them no time for rest; he roused them, and kept them on the go until the priceless supplies had been collected within the shelter of the brush. Then he broke open certain packages and distributed arms among his followers.

The three Americans, who were munching a tasteless breakfast of pilot bread, were joined by Major Ramos. "I am dispatching a message to General Gomez's headquarters, asking him to send a pack train and an escort for these supplies. There is danger here; perhaps you would like to go on with the couriers."

O'Reilly accepted eagerly; then thinking of the girl, he said doubtfully: "I'm afraid Miss Evans isn't equal to the trip."

"Nonsense! I'm equal to anything," Norine declared. And indeed she looked capable enough as she stood there in her short walking suit and stout boots. Branch walked down the invitation, vowing that he was too weak to budge. If there was the faintest prospect of riding to the interior he infinitely preferred to await the opportunity, he said, even at the risk of an attack by Spanish soldiers in the meantime.

It took O'Reilly but a short time to collect the few articles necessary for the trip; indeed, his bundle was so small that Norine was dismayed.

"Can't I take any clothes?" she inquired in a panic. "I can't live without a change."

"It is something you'll have to learn," he told her. "An insurrection with two shirts is wealthy. Some of them haven't any."

"Isn't it likely to rain on us?"

"It's almost sure to."

Miss Evans pondered this prospect; then she laughed. "It must feel funny," she said.

There were three other members of the traveling party, men who knew something of the country round about; they were good fighters, doubtless, but in spite of their shiny new weapons they resembled soldiers even less than did their major. All were dressed as they had been when they left New York; one even wore a derby hat and pointed patent-leather shoes. Nevertheless Norine Evans thought the little cavalcade presented quite a martial appearance as it fled away into the jungle.

The first few miles were trying, for the coast was swampy and thickly grown up to underbrush; but in time the jungle gave place to higher timber and to open savannas deep in guinea grass. Soon after noon the travelers came to a farm, the owner of which was known to one of the guides, and here a stop was made in order to secure horses and food.

Johnnie, who was badly fagged from the previous night's work, found a shady spot and stretched himself out for a nap.

The shade was grateful. O'Reilly enjoyed his sleep.

The party had penetrated to the foothills of the Sierra de Cubitas, and as they ascended, the scenery changed. Rarely is the Cuban landscape anything but pleasing. It is a smiling island. It has been said, too, that everything in it is friendly to man; the people are amiable, warm-hearted; the very animals and insects are harmless. But here in the Cubitas range all was different. The land was stern and forbidding; canyons deep and damp raised dripping walls to the sky; bridge paths skirted ledges that were bold and fearsome, or lost themselves in gloomy jungles as noisome as Spanish dungeons. Hidden away in these fastnesses, the rebel government had established its capital. Here, safe from surprise, the soldiers of Gomez and Maceo and Garcia rested between attacks, nursing their wounded and recruiting their strength for further sallies.

It was a strange seat of government—no nation ever had a stranger—for the state buildings were huts of bark and leaves, the army was uniformed in rags. Cook fires smoldered in the open glades; cavalry horses grazed in the grassy streets, and wood smoke drifted over them.

The second evening brought O'Reilly and Miss Evans safely through, and at news of the expedition's success a pack train was made ready to go to its assistance. Norine's letter from the New York junta was read, and the young woman was warmly welcomed. One of the better huts was vacated for her use, and the officers of the provisional government called to pay their respects.

There were other Americans in Cubitas, as O'Reilly soon discovered. During his first inspection of the village he heard himself hailed in his own language, and a young man in dirty white trousers and jacket strode toward him.

"Welcome to our city!" the stranger cried. "I'm Judson, captain of artillery, departments del Oriente; and you're the fellow who came with the quinine lady, aren't you?"

O'Reilly acknowledged his identity, and Judson grinned. "Have you met the old man?" he inquired. "General Gomez?"

"No; I'd like to meet him."

"Come along, then; I'll introduce you."

Gen. Maximo Gomez, father of patriots, bulwark of the Cuban cause, was seated in a hammock, reading some letters; O'Reilly recognized him instantly from the many pictures he had seen. He looked up at Judson's salute and then turned a pair of brilliant eyes, as hard as glass, upon O'Reilly. His was an irascible, brooding face; it had in it something of the sternness, the exalted detachment, of the eagle, and O'Reilly gained a hint of the personality behind it. Maximo Gomez was counted one of the world's ablest guerrilla leaders; and indeed it had required the quenchless enthusiasm of a real military genius to fuse into a homogeneous fighting force the ill-assorted rabble of nondescript women Gomez led, to school them to privation and to render them sufficiently mobile to defy successfully ten times their number of trained troops. This, however, was precisely what the old Porto Rican had done, and in doing it he had won the admiration of military students.

With a bluntness not unkind he asked O'Reilly what had brought him to Cuba.

When O'Reilly explained the reason for his presence the old fighter nodded.

"So? You wish to go west, eh?"

"Yes, sir. I want to find Colonel Lopez."

"Lopez? Miguel Lopez?" the general inquired quickly. "Well, you won't have to look far for him." General Gomez's leathery countenance lightened into a smile. "He happens to be right here in Cubitas." Calling Judson to him, he said: "Amigo, take Mr. O'Reilly to Colonel Lopez; you will find him somewhere about. I am sorry we are not to have this young fellow for a soldier; he looks like a real man and quite equal to five quintos, eh?"

It was the habit of the Cubans to refer to their enemies as quintos—the fifth part of a man! With a wave of his hand Gomez returned to his reading.

Col. Miguel Lopez, a handsome, animated fellow, took O'Reilly's hand in a hearty clasp when they were introduced; but a moment later his smile gave way to a frown and his brow darkened.

"So! You are that O'Reilly from Matanzas," said he. "I know you now, but I never expected we would meet." "Esteban Varona told you about me, did he not?"

The colonel inclined his head.

"I'm here at last, after the devil's own time. I've been trying every way to get through. The Spaniards stopped me at Puerto Principe—they sent me back home, you know. I've been perfectly crazy. I—You—"

O'Reilly swallowed hard. "You know where Esteban is? Tell me."

"Have you heard nothing?"

"Nothing whatever. That is, nothing since Rosa, his sister—You understand, she and I are engaged—"

"Yes, yes; Esteban told me all about you."

Something in the Cuban's gravity of manner gave O'Reilly warning. A sudden fear assailed him. His voice shook as he asked:

"What is it? Not bad news?"

There was no need for the officer to answer. In his averted gaze O'Reilly read confirmation of his sickening apprehensions.

"Tell me! Which one?" he whispered.

"Both!"

O'Reilly recoiled; a spasm distorted his chalky face. He began to shake weakly, and his fingers plucked aimlessly at each other.

Lopez took him by the arm. "Try to control yourself," said he. "Sit here while I try to tell you what little I know. Or would it not be better to wait awhile, until you are calmer?" As the young man made no answer, except to stare at him in a white agony of suspense, he sighed:

"I will tell you all I know—which isn't much. Esteban Varona came to me soon after he and his sister had fled from their home; he wanted to join my forces, but we were harassed on every side, and I didn't dare take the girl—no woman could have endured the hardships we suffered. So I convinced him that his first duty was to her, rather than to his country, and he agreed. He was a fine boy! He had spirit. He bought some stolen rifles and armed a band of his own—which wasn't a bad idea. I used to hear about him. Nobody cared to molest him, I can tell you, until finally he killed some of the regular troops. Then of course they went after him. Meanwhile he managed to destroy his own plantations, which Cueto had robbed him of. You know Cueto?"

"Yes."

"Well, Esteban put an end to him after a while; rode right up to La Joya one night, broke in the door, and munched the scoundrel in his bed. But there was a mistake of some sort. It seems that a body of Cobo's volunteers were somewhere close by, and the two parties met. I have never learned all the details of the affair, and the stories of that fight which came to me are too preposterous for belief. Still, Esteban and his men must have fought like demons, for they killed some incredible number. But they were human—they could not defeat a regiment. It seems that only one or two of them escaped."

"Esteban? Did he—"

Colonel Lopez nodded; then he said gravely: "Cobo takes no prisoners. I was in the Rubi hills at the time, fighting hard, and it was six weeks before I got back into Matanzas. Naturally, when I heard what happened, I tried to find the girl, but Weyer was concentrating the pacificos by the time, and there was nobody left in the Yumuri; it was a desert."

"Then you don't know positively that she—"

"Wait. There is no doubt that the boy was killed, but of Rosa's fate I can only form my own opinion. However, one of Esteban's men joined my troops later, and I not only learned something about the girl, but also why Esteban had been so relentlessly pursued. It was all Cobo's doings. You have heard of the fellow? No? Well, you will. The speaker's tone was eloquent of hatred. "He is worse than the worst of them—a monster! He had seen Miss Varona. She was a beautiful girl."

"Go on!" whispered the lover.

"I discovered that she didn't at first obey Weyer's edict. She and the two negroes—they were former slaves of her father, I believe—took refuge in the Pan de Matanzas. Later on, Cobo's men made a raid and killed a great many. Some few escaped into the high ravines, but Miss Varona was not one of them. Out of regard for Esteban I made careful search, but I could find no trace of her."

"And yet you don't know what happened?" O'Reilly ventured. "You're not sure?"

"No, but I tell you again Cobo's men take no prisoners. When I heard about that raid I gave up looking for her."

"This—Cobo," the American's voice shook in spite of his effort to hold it steady—"I shall hope to meet him some time."

(Continued in next issue.)

MORGANS ACCUSED BY SENATOR BORAH OF BACKING LEAGUE

WASHINGTON, June 30.—The league of nations covenant and the influences at work to secure its acceptance by the United States furnished the vehicle today for another long debate in the senate.

Renewing his charge that international bankers are sponsoring the league for selfish purposes, Senator Borah, Republican, of Idaho, charged that Thomas W. Lamont, a partner in the Morgan banking house, had purchased the New York Evening Post as part of a propaganda to force senate acceptance of the covenant. He charged the league to enforce peace, headed by former President Taft, was also controlled by the bankers.

Senator Hitchcock, Democrat, of Nebraska, defending Mr. Taft and his organization, replied that not only business men, but organized labor, the churches, the farmers and the people generally were demanding ratification of the covenant.

ARMISTICE BROKEN
PARIS, June 28.—The armistice entered into several days ago by the Poles and Ukrainians has been broken by an advance by the Ukrainian forces.

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MAYOR OF PORTLAND TAKES ADVANTAGE OF NEWLY CREATED LAW

PORTLAND, June 1.—For the purpose of ending the existing strike of the electrical workers and operators of the Pacific Telephone & Telegraph company in Oregon, and to secure an amicable adjustment between the striking employees and the company, Mayor Baker has summoned the newly-created state board of conciliation into session.

The conciliation board, provision for which was made at the last session of the legislature, will go into session tomorrow. Its organization meeting in the forenoon. After a preliminary session, its members will ask for the appointment of committees, from the employees and the company, or officials of either, and will take up the issues in dispute. Members of the board are Otto Hartwig, president of the state federation of labor; W. F. Woodward and J. K. Flynn.

The organization meeting of the conciliation board will be held at 9 o'clock tomorrow morning at the offices of Mr. Woodward. Immediately afterward the board will summon strike officials and officials of the company to appear before it and present their views of the controversy.

CHARGES OF MUTINY ON RUSSIAN FRONT DENIED BY OFFICERS

NEW YORK, June 30.—Denial that Company I, 339th infantry, mutinied and refused to go to the front in the Archangel sector was made today by Captain H. G. Winslow, the company commander, who returned aboard the transport Von Staeben, which brought 46 officers and 1495 men of the 339th, the first units to return from the Archangel front.

"This is all that happened," said Captain Winslow. "A sergeant ordered a Polish boy to load a truck. The boy refused. When an officer arrived he found that the private misunderstood his orders because he did not understand the English language. When the orders were explained to him he carried them out. That was all there was to it. No punishment was meted out."

MEXICANS SEIZE FISH

Galveston Texas, June 30.—The fishing schooner Cape Horn, owned by the Gulf Fisheries, Incorporated, of Galveston, arrived here last night with a hungry crew, after having been held by Mexican officials at Vera Cruz for two months, on a charge of fishing in Mexican territorial waters. Then released a week ago and sent to sea, provisioned only with bread and water, according to Captain Marcus Brandt, commander of the vessel.

Bodies and Minds

Under a law enacted at the last legislature every school district in Oregon will be compelled to devote a portion of its day to what the law terms physical education. This may be simple calisthenics, but it is evidently the intention of the legislature to provide that large school districts shall so arrange their curriculum that students of high schools and upper grades may be taught to properly care for their bodies.

Oregon City is not equipped at all for work of this kind. We have first class schools, from the scholastic standpoint, but our physical education has been neglected and hampered through lack of facilities and equipment.

It would be an excellent investment to erect here a school gymnasium, so that our boys and girls could be properly fitted and trained for the sake of their bodies, as well as their minds.

ARMY ENLISTMENTS TO BE WITHDRAWN FOR SERVICE IN FRANCE

PORTLAND, June 30.—After July 5, no more men will be accepted for enlistment in the regular army for service in the American expeditionary forces in France or Germany. Strenuous efforts are being made to fill up the gaps in the peace time military establishment before that date. Enlistment for service in the United States and insular possessions will continue, however.

According to Colonel Martin, in charge of the local recruiting bureau, all men not members of the regular army, who are now in service abroad, will be discharged before July 12, and for this reason the war department desires to fill up the gaps in the A. E. F. before that date. Men who enlist before July 5 are assured of a trip to France, the colonel declares, and on enlistment will be sent immediately to Camp Meade, Md., for training.

The possibility of service in Syria, Armenia and Turkey is offered as an inducement for recruits, with opportunities of education.

Millions Are Taught By One Instructor

BOSTON, June 30.—Henry W. Rankin of the naval training station claims to have taught more persons to sing "The Star Spangled Banner" than any other individual in the country in the past two decades. Up to a few months ago he was the musical director at the station. Ill health caused him to take up other work. Mr. Rankin states that he does not feel that it is an overstatement that he has taught or directed the national anthem to more than a million persons. His largest chorus was in August, 1917, when he led nearly 14,000 voices in singing the national anthem accompanied by a band of 125 pieces.

18 AMERICANS ARE KILLED BY RUSSIANS AND MANY WOUNDED

WASHINGTON, June 30.—Eighteen American soldiers were killed, one officer and eight men severely wounded in an engagement with anti-Kolchak forces near Romanovka on June 25.

Major General Graves, commanding the American expedition in Siberia, informed the war department today that the engagement followed an attack by the Bolsheviks on railroad guards.

YANKS BATTLE WITH FRENCH. MANY KILLED

BREST, June 30.—Two French civilians were killed and five American soldiers and sailors were injured and more than 100 wounded in riots here last night. Two of the American soldiers are expected to die.

The casualties occurred as a result of the exchange of shots between American military and naval police and French sailors. The trouble began, according to available accounts, when an American naval officer, who is said to have been drinking heavily, tore down a French flag and trampled on it. A crowd of Frenchmen attacked the officer and it is said, kicked and beat him until he was unconscious.

Americans who passed by and who were not aware of the cause of the fight went to the aid of the naval officer. The fight then became general.

FERGUSON FIRE WARDEN

SALEM, June 28.—State Forester F. A. Elliott has announced the appointment of a district fire warden for the 1919 season in this county, J. W. Ferguson, Jr., of Molalla.

ELECTRICAL WORKERS JOIN OPERATORS IN TELEPHONE STRIKE

PORTLAND, July 1.—All electrical workers employed by the Pacific Telephone & Telegraph company throughout the state were called out on strike this morning in compliance with a strike vote taken last night by the members of local No. 125, International Brotherhood of Electrical Workers. According to T. C. Lowry, business manager of the local, the members responded 100 per cent strong and slightly more than 400 men are reported out this morning by Lowry.

This number, added to the most recent estimates of the Telephone Operators' union, which places the number of striking operators at more than 500, brings the total number of men and women in the state now on strike against the telephone company to slightly over 900.

Opposed to this statement is an official announcement made this morning by W. J. Phillips, representing the telephone company, in which the number of striking operators is estimated at about 20 per cent of the total of 850 employed in Portland by the company.

Portland Elks Are To Celebrate

PORTLAND, June 30.—Portland Elks will help their Astoria brethren initiate a large class at the City-by-the-Sea July 12. The local lodge has chartered the steamer Kellogg and will leave here at 12:30 p. m. There will be "stunts" on the down trip. When Astoria is reached, the women will be taken on to Seaside, rooms having been reserved there for 250. After the lodge session the Elks will go to the Seaside beach to administer the third degree; here the Mrs. Elks may join their husbands. On Sunday trips will be taken to Elk creek and other points of interest. A clam chowder party will be enjoyed during the day. The visitors will leave Seaside in time to make connections with the night boat for Portland.

Plane of New Type Is Speedy

LONDON, June 30.—The first "lightning plane" has been delivered. These are the machines General Seely, the head of the air service, referred to when he announced a new type of plane "beyond imagination." In tabloid form this is the "lightning plane." Three hundred and twenty horsepower A. B. C. radial engine, speed of 160 miles an hour near the ground. Can climb to 20,000 feet in 20 minutes and there maintain a speed of 120 miles an hour. Has fireproof tank, two machine guns and racks for 20 one-pound bombs.